Mix it

Look at what comes after the marker: a noun, a subject and a verb, a verb or a new person.

idea	marker	what comes next

because · so · although · while SUJEITO + VERBO	Although the film was long, I enjoyed it. The shop was closed, so we went home.	Cada lado tem o seu sujeito e o seu verbo. Nunca although + but.
because of · due to · thanks to SÓ UM NOME	The match stopped because of the storm.	Depois vem um nome. Thanks to é uma razão boa.
despite · in spite of UM NOME OU -ING	Despite the noise, he fell asleep.	"Despite" não leva "of". "In spite of" leva.
during · for · while QUANDO E QUANTO TEMPO	He called during dinner. We waited for an hour.	During + nome. For + quanto tempo. While + sujeito e verbo.
to · so that PARA QUÊ	I called **to** ask. I wrote it down **so that** he could read it.	A mesma pessoa: to + verbo. Outro sujeito: so that + could.
for her to OUTRA PESSOA	I kept a seat for my aunt **to** sit in.	Depois de "for": me, you, him, her, us, them. Depois, to + verbo.

ERRORS TO AVOID

~~Despite of~~ the rain, I went out. · say: **Despite the rain, I went out.**

I went out ~~for buy~~ bread. · say: **I went out to buy bread.**

She stayed home ~~because of~~ she was ill. · say: **She stayed home because she was ill.**

We left the door open ~~for the dog come~~ in. · say: **We left the door open for the dog to come in.**

QUICK RULES

Nome depois: because of, due to, thanks to, despite, during. **Sujeito e verbo depois:** because, although, while, so.

Para quê: mesmo sujeito, "to" + verbo. Outro sujeito, "so that" + could ou "for" + pessoa + "to".

Not: vai antes do "to": so as not to. Aqui não cabe "for".